

ALEX WEIJIE CHOW

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Jan 2026

EDUCATION

- 2020 – **Ph.D. Candidate, Sociology**
Present *Stanford University, Stanford, CA*
Doctoral Thesis: “The Social Significance of Education.”
Dissertation Committee: Dr. Michelle Jackson (Advisor),
Dr. Florencia Torche, Dr. David Grusky
Qualifying Exams: Social Stratification, Economic Sociology
- 2022 **Master of Arts, Sociology**
Stanford University, Stanford, CA
Master’s Thesis: “Expansion and Returns: A Causal Inference
Approach to the Positional Value of Education.” (Co-Advisors: Dr.
Michelle Jackson, Dr. Florencia Torche)
- 2016 – 2020 **Bachelor of Arts, Sociology (Honours)**
University of British Columbia, Vancouver, B.C.
Honors Thesis: “Complicating the International Student Classification
in Canada: A Computational Grounded Theory Approach”
(Supervisor: Dr. Qiang Fu)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social Stratification, Inequality, Mobility, Educational Inequality, Higher Education,
Quantitative & Statistical Methods, Computational Methods, Network Analysis, Natural
Language Processing

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

Chow, Alex, and Neil Guppy. 2021. “Intergenerational Educational Mobility Over the Past
Century in Canada.” *Canadian Review of Sociology*.

Works in Progress

Chow, Alex. “The Subjective Social Ladder: Actual, Perceived, and Projected Mobility in 22
Countries.” *Under review*.

Chow, Alex. “How Much Does Education Matter for Social Status? Findings from a Conjoint
Experiment.” *In preparation*.

Qiao, Si, Junxi Qu, Rosina Pradhananga, **Alex Chow**, Sarah-Eve Dill, David Grusky, and
Anthony Gar-On Yeh. “Residential Relocation Reshapes Daily Exposure Segregation.”
Under review.

van der Velden, Max, David Grusky, and **Alex Chow**. “A Supervised LLM System for Large-
Scale, Data-Secure Qualitative Coding.” *In preparation*.

FELLOWSHIPS

2020 – 2023	Knight-Hennessy Scholars Program, Stanford University
2019	Data Science for Social Good (DSSG) Fellowship, Data Science Institute, UBC

RESEARCH GRANTS

2025	Graduate Research Opportunity, Stanford School of Humanities and Sciences
2025	Sociology PhD Dissertation Research Opportunity, Stanford Department of Sociology

HONORS & AWARDS

2020	Governor General's Silver Medal in Arts, UBC
2020	Outstanding Graduating Student, Canadian Sociological Association
2020	Kaspar Naegele Memorial Prize in Sociology, UBC
2019	University of British Columbia Scholarship, UBC
2019, 2018	Faculty of Arts International Student Scholarship, UBC
2019, 2018	Katherine Brearley Arts Scholarship, UBC
2018	Mo Lin Yu Memorial Prize in the Faculty of Arts, UBC

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Jan 2026	"How Much Does Education Matter for Social Status? Findings from a Conjoint Experiment." RC28 Online Meeting on Educational Inequalities, SciencesPo, France (Virtual).
Aug 2025	"Perceptions of Social Status: Findings from a Conjoint Experiment." American Sociological Association Annual Meeting 2025, Chicago, IL.
Nov 2023	"Leveraging Cell Phone Data for Studying Social Mobility." New Methods to Measure Intergenerational Mobility, Stone Center for Research on Wealth Inequality and Mobility, University of Chicago, IL.
Aug 2023	"The Subjective Social Ladder: Actual, Perceived, and Projected Mobility in 22 Countries." American Sociological Association Annual Meeting 2023, Philadelphia, PA.
Jun 2022	"The Post-Liberal Social Classes: Actual and Perceived Levels of Income Inequality and Associated Values." International Sociological Association World Congress of Sociology 2023, Melbourne, Australia.
Aug 2022	"Expansion and Returns: A Causal Inference Approach to the Positional Value of Education." American Sociological Association Annual Meeting 2022, Los Angeles, CA.
2021	"Intergenerational Educational Assortative Mating: A Study of Individuals Born Between 1970 and 1985."
Aug 2021	American Sociological Association Annual Meeting 2021, Virtual.
May 2021	Canadian Population Society Annual Meeting 2021, Virtual.
2019	"Intergenerational Educational Mobility Over the Past Century in Canada."
Aug 2019	American Sociological Association Annual Meeting 2019 (Honors Program), New York, NY.
Jun 2019	Canadian Sociological Association Annual Meeting 2019, Vancouver, BC.
May 2019	UBC Anthropology and Sociology Undergraduate Conference 2019, Vancouver, BC.
Mar 2019	UBC Multidisciplinary Undergraduate Research Conference 2019, Vancouver, BC.
Jan 2019	Harvard University National Collegiate Research Conference 2019, Cambridge, MA.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Stanford University (2020 – Present)

- Jun 2025 – **Voices Lab: “American Voices Project.”** Research Assistant for Dr. David Grusky, *Stanford Center on Poverty and Inequality*.
Present
Mar 2023 – **Social Networks Lab: “Social Networks and Cellphone Mobility Data.”**
Present Lab Coordinator and Research Assistant for Dr. David Grusky, *Stanford Center on Poverty and Inequality*
Sep 2022 – **“COVID and Infant Health.”** Research Assistant for Dr. Florencia Torche,
May 2023 *Stanford Department of Sociology*

University of British Columbia (2016 – 2020)

- May 2018 – **“Intergenerational Educational Mobility Over the Past Century in**
May 2021 **Canada.”** Co-Investigator with Dr. Neil Guppy, *UBC Department of Sociology*
May 2019 – **“Developing Natural Language Processing Tools for Sharing of**
Dec 2019 **Indigenous and Community Knowledge.”** 2019 Data Science for Social
Good Research Fellow, *National Energy Board & UBC Data Science Institute*
May 2019 – **“Romantic Relationships in Canada.”** Research Assistant for Dr. Yue Qian,
Dec 2019 *UBC Department of Sociology*

TEACHING & MENTORSHIP

Stanford University (2020 – 2025)

- 2021 – 2023 **Graduate Teaching Assistant.**
Jan 2023 – SOC 382: *Sociological Methodology II – Statistics for an Open Science: Principles of*
Mar 2023 *Regression II* by Dr. Michelle Jackson, *Stanford Department of Sociology*
Sep 2022 – SOC 381: *Sociological Methodology I – Introduction* by Sasha Shen Johfre, *Stanford*
Dec 2022 *Department of Sociology*
Sep 2021 – SOC 114/214: *Economic Sociology* by Dr. Mark Granovetter, *Stanford Department of*
Dec 2021 *Sociology*
Nov 2024 – **Graduate Research Assistant Internship Supervisor.** Stanford Institute for
Aug 2025 Research in the Social Sciences Research Experience Program, *Stanford School of*
Humanities and Sciences
Jun 2021 – **Graduate Research Mentor.** Stanford Summer Research Early Identification
Aug 2021 Program with Dr. David Grusky, *Stanford School of Humanities and Sciences*

University of British Columbia (2016 – 2020)

- 2018 – 2020 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant.**
May 2020 – ANTH/SOCI 480: *Urban Ethnographic Field School* by Dr. Kerry Greer and Dr.
Jun 2020 Patrick Moore, *UBC Departments of Anthropology and Sociology*
Jan 2020 – SOCI 372: *Contemporary Directions in Theory* by Dr. Sanjeev Routray, *UBC Department*
Apr 2020 *of Sociology*
Sep 2019 – DSCI 100: *Introduction to Data Science* by Dr. Tiffany Timbers, Dr. Trevor Campbell,
Apr 2020 and Dr. Melissa Lee, *UBC Department of Statistics*
Sep 2019 – SOCI 301: *Development and Underdevelopment* by Dr. Oral Robinson, *UBC Department*
Dec 2019 *of Sociology*
Sep 2018 – SOCI 100: *Introduction to Sociology* by Dr. Kerry Greer, *UBC Department of Sociology*
May 2019
Sep 2019 – **Student Directed Seminar Leader and Coordinator.** SOCI 433: *Scaling the*
Apr 2020 *Ivory Tower – Sociology of Higher Education* (Faculty Sponsor: Dr. Neil Guppy), *UBC Department of Sociology*

Oct 2019 **Workshop Leader and Coordinator.** Undergraduate Social Statistics Study Group, *UBC Department of Sociology*

Sep 2017 – **Mentorship Program Coordinator (2018-2019) | Peer Mentor (2017-2019)**

Apr 2019 Coordinated Arts Program, *UBC Arts First Year Programs*

ACADEMIC SERVICE

University of British Columbia (2016 – 2020)

Jan 2019 – **Advisory Committee Member.** Advanced Research Cohort (ARC) Program, May 2020
UBC Department of Sociology

Jan 2019 – **Tenure-Track Instructor Hiring Committee Member.** Coordinated Arts May 2019
 Program, Arts First Year Programs, *UBC Faculty of Arts*

Sep 2017 – **Lead Typesetter (2018- 2019) | Associate Editor (2017-2018)** Sojourners: May 2019
 Undergraduate Journal of Sociology, *UBC Department of Sociology*

Feb 2018 **Selection Panel Member.** Arts Undergraduate Society Humanities and Social Sciences Conference, *UBC*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Python, R, Stata

LANGUAGES

English, Mandarin

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

American Sociological Association
Canadian Sociological Association
Canadian Population Society
International Sociological Association